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Players of this decade like Nick Kyrgios (above) and Benoit Paire (right), crave attention so much and compete so little that they masochistically self-destruct with underhand serves and other foolish shots on big points.

Tiriac), he surely would have achieved much more had he not been a compulsive jokester and provocateur. The incorrigible Romanian 'mooned' a referee, threw his shoe at a baseline judge who had called a foot fault on him, and changed his shorts *during* a match. Once he let a stubborn umpire know it was raining too hard to keep playing by standing under an umbrella (he borrowed from a fan) to receive serve.

Bud Collins, the esteemed journalist and broadcaster, nicknamed him 'the Bucharest Buffoon,' while others called him (just plain) 'Nasty.' During a London indoor tournament against Nastase, a ruggedly built Clark Graebner, who was furious at the Romanian's baiting the crowd, officials, and him, hopped over the net, jabbed his opponent in the chest, and warned him not to try any more dirty tricks. His bluff called, a terrified Nastase walked off the court, saying "I'm too frightened to continue." Nastase and a forgiving Graebner, who were friends and occasional doubles partners, went drinking afterward.

Other incidents ended less happily. In a mixed doubles match at Nice, Nasty whacked Frenchwoman Gail Chanfreau in the body with powerful volleys.